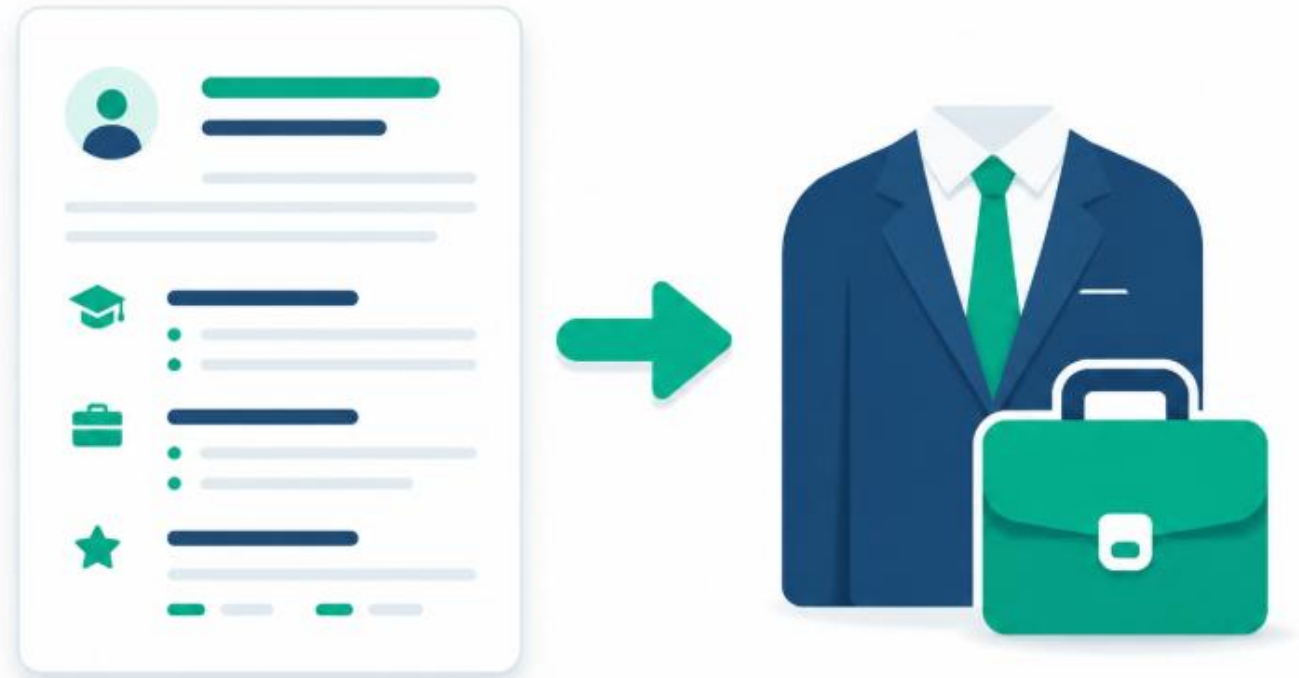


CV Writing and Interviewing Skills



Session Learning Objectives

By the end of this session, participants will learn how to:

- 1 Recall the hiring process and describe how an ATS screens a CV.
- 2 Explain the purpose of every CV section and what a recruiter looks for in it.
- 3 Apply CV writing rules using action verbs, evidence, and measurable results.
- 4 Analyse weak and strong CV samples to identify the errors that cost an interview.
- 5 Evaluate AI-generated CV content and interview answers against the job advert.
- 6 Create a tailored CV and a set of STAR-structured interview answers.

Key Topics Covered

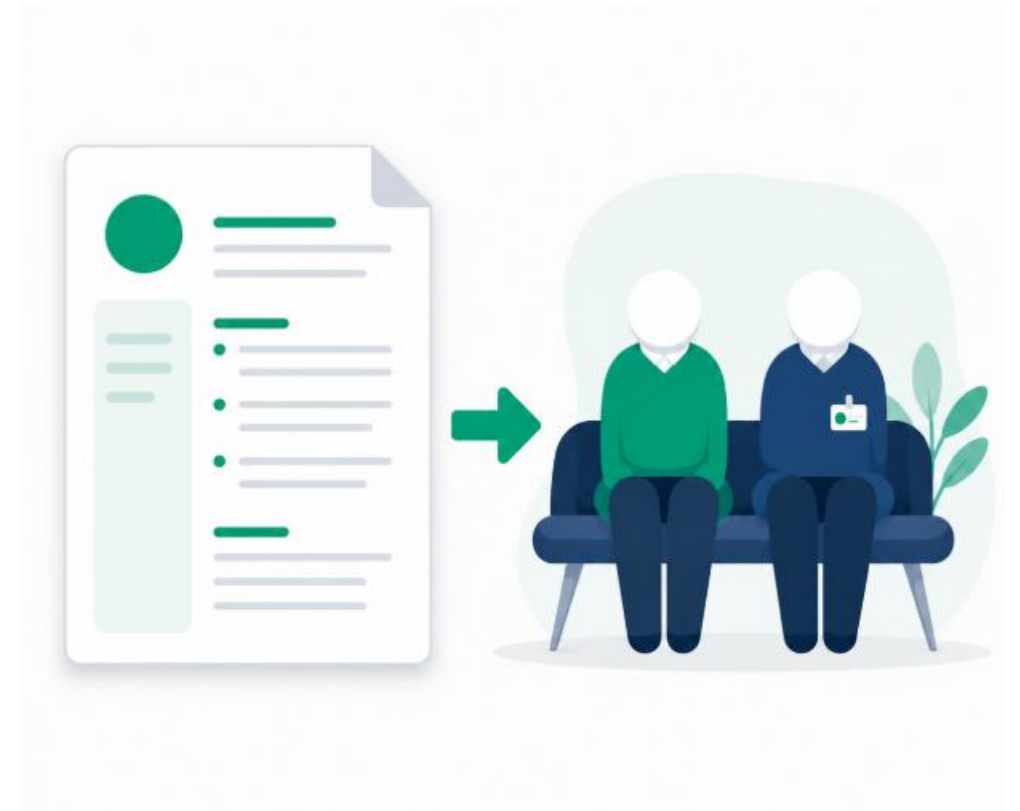
- Why we write a CV
- The hiring process
- Applicant Tracking Systems
- The CV sections, one by one
- Real samples: weak and strong
- **AI Activity: tailor your CV**
- Layout and formatting rules
- The final CV checklist
- Competency-based interviews
- Preparing: ten tips
- Sample interview questions
- The STAR method
- **AI Activity: rehearse the interview**
- Recap and assignment

Why Do We Write a CV?

To get an INTERVIEW

Not to get the job. Only the meeting.

- Add what is relevant to this job
- Cut what belongs to another one
- Prove it, never just claim it



What That Means in Practice

Three habits that separate a shortlisted CV from an ignored one.

1

Relevance over completeness

Your CV is not an archive. Every line supports this one application.

2

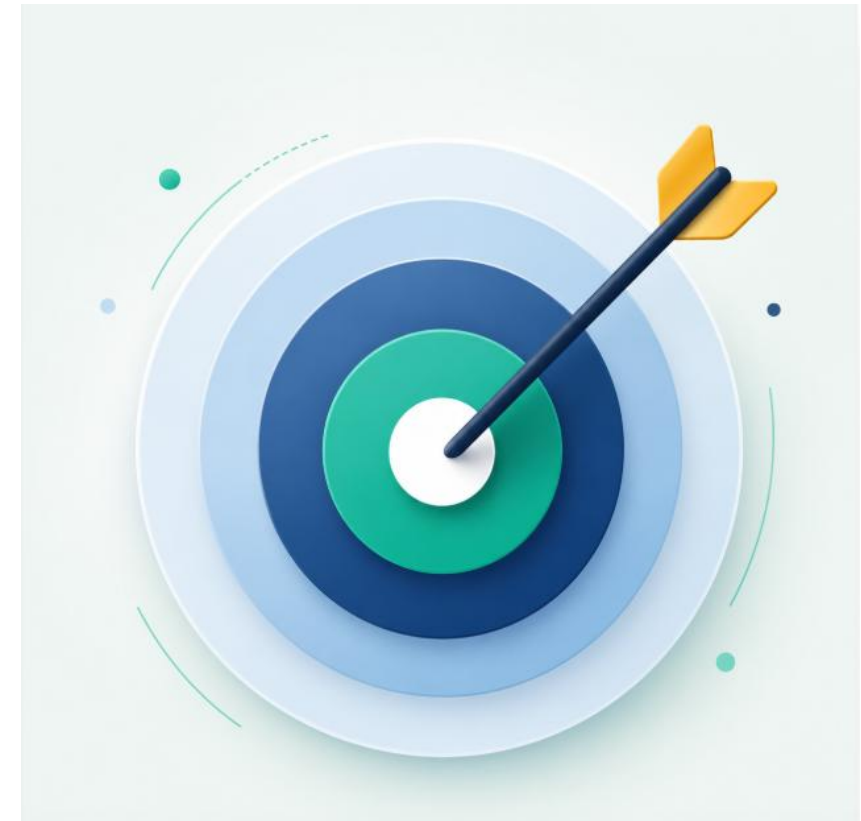
Evidence over adjectives

Hard worker proves nothing. A result with a number proves everything.

3

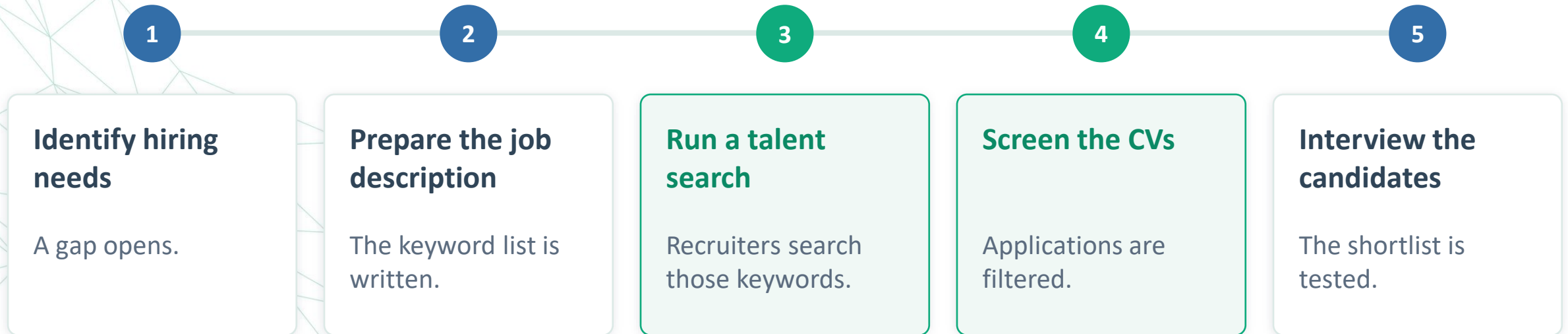
Scanned before it is read

The first pass takes seconds. If the match is not visible, the CV is set aside.



The Hiring Process

Five steps. Your CV decides two of them.



Where Your CV Enters the Process

Two gates, two different tests.

Talent search

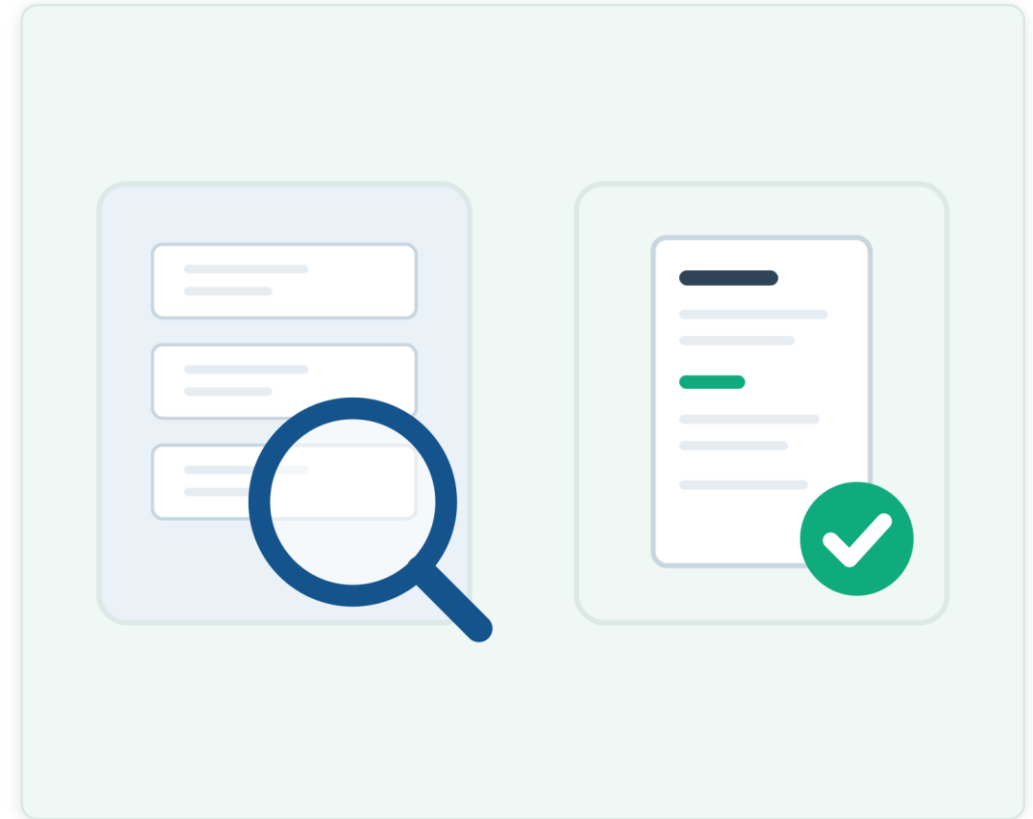
FINDABILITY

If the advert's words are missing from your CV, you never appear in the results.

CV screening

RELEVANCE

Missing evidence reads as a missing skill. Irrelevant lines push relevant ones down.



What is an ATS?

Applicant Tracking System

Software used by recruiters to track candidates through the hiring process. It automatically scans and sorts applications by keywords, skills, and experience.

It is not a judge of quality. It is a filter that reads structure and vocabulary.



How an ATS Reads Your CV

1

Parse

It breaks your file into fields. A layout it cannot read becomes an empty field.

2

Match

It compares those fields against the words the employer used in the advert.

3

Rank

It orders applications so the recruiter opens the strongest matches first.

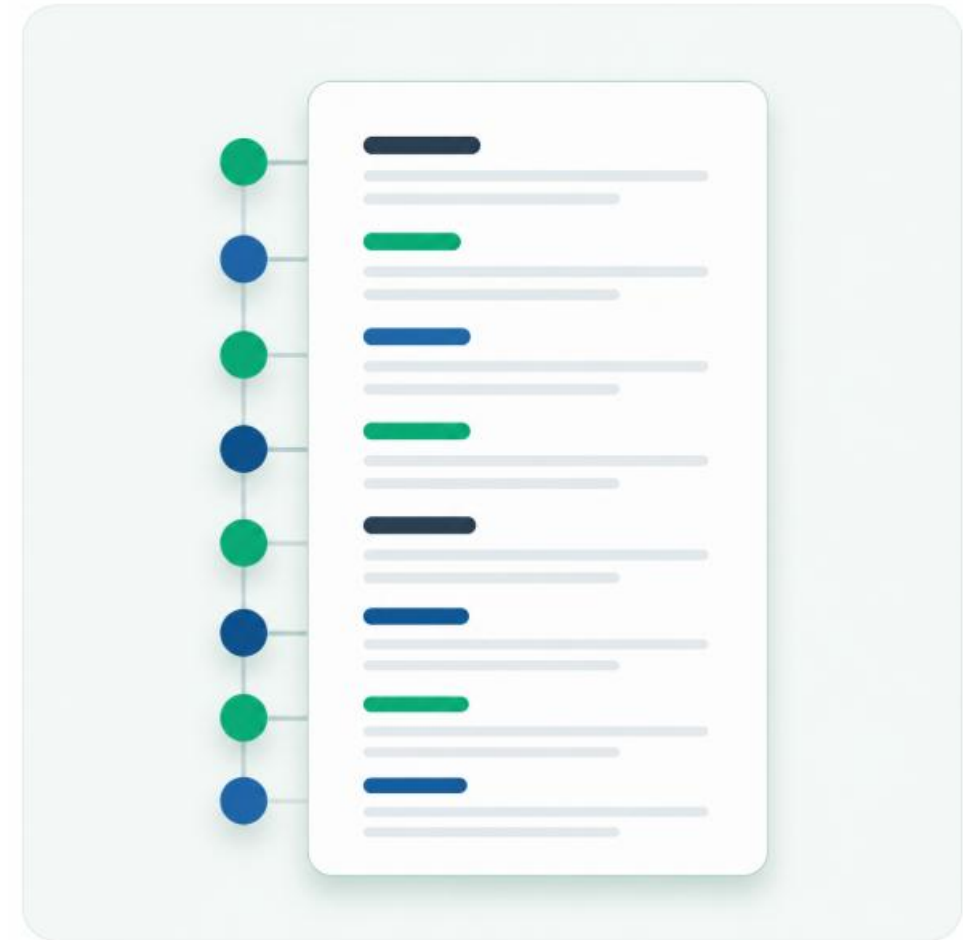


Staying ATS-Friendly

- Use the advert's own job title
- Write technology names in full
- Keep standard section headings
- One column. No tables or text boxes
- Never put evidence inside an image



What Are the CV Sections?



Contact Information: Common Mistakes

Three real samples. Look before you read the verdict.



Contact Me

+20-1[REDACTED] 034
[REDACTED]010@gmail.com
shobra
Cairo, EGYPT

Ahmed Fahim El-bahy

Chemist

[REDACTED]@gmail.com • +[REDACTED]178481 • Cairo, Egypt • 10/12/1999 • complete

Ahmed Mohsen Hanafy

Software Engineer

Tel. No.: [REDACTED]20 Email:
[REDACTED]sen9623@gmail.com
GitHub: github.com/[REDACTED]

Nationality : Egyptian

Date of Birth : 6th Nov 1998

Military status : Completed

Address : Cairo, Egypt

WHY THESE FAIL

- Personal data no employer may ask for: date of birth, nationality, marital and military status.
- Contact details drawn as icons only. A parser reads no label and leaves the field empty.
- An informal email address, and a district instead of city and country.

Contact Information: Strong Example

Everything a recruiter needs, in plain text, in four lines.

Ammar Mohamed Azooz

0100xxxxxxxx | Dokki, Giza, Egypt

a.m.azooz@email.com

linkedin.com/in/ammaraazooz/

WHY THIS WORKS

- Full name at the top, larger than anything else on the page.
- Phone, city and country, email and LinkedIn, all as readable text.
- No date of birth, no nationality, no marital status, no photograph.

Ammar Mohamed Azooz		
0100xxxxxxxx Dokki, Giza, Egypt a.m.azooz@email.com linkedin.com/in/ammaraazooz/		
Education		
Faculty of Commerce, English Section , Cairo University (June 2019)		
Major: Business		
Grade:		
Work Experience		
Senior Recruitment Specialist , LAMAR Egypt (Feb.2019 - Present)		
• Perform the full life cycle of recruitment for white-collar employees. • Perform full recruitment process for massive blue-collar employees for Lamar DC's and Nubaria Plant • Ensure job profiles and position requirements are aligned with business objectives.		
Internships		
Teacher , The Nest Nursery and Preschool Institution (Aug.2017-Sep.2017)		
• Teach preschoolers English, Arabic, and Art basics. • Prepare lesson plans and schedules.		
Extracurricular Activities		
President and Project Manager , VIA Club, Cairo University (2017- 2018)		
• Managed a team of 100 members. • Created a program of 4 phases with 7 strong multinational companies (IBM, Cisco, Vodafone, UNODC, Deloitte, P&G, and Allianz). • Funded our project with funds worth 50,000 EGP. • Reached 55+k through our social media platform.		
Courses		
Digital Marketing Course , Udemy, 75 Hours (Nov.2021)		
Skills		
Computer Skills:	Language Skills:	Computer Language Skills:
• MS Package • AutoCad	• Arabic: Native • English: Very Good • French: Very Good	• C++ • Python
Projects		
Tappeti (March.2022)		
Tappeti is an efficient admin dashboard website for managing carpet sales and factory resources. Built with Angular and Angular Material, it streamlines operations and enhances resource management.		
Familiar With:		
• Photoshop	• Javascript	• Illustrator

Career Objective: Common Mistakes

Two samples. Both well written, both useless to a recruiter.

Objective

My Motivating factor is to be an added value to the place I join and to see that I am positively contributing to the post I hold and to the organization I serve loyally. I work very hard with calibers, pushing them to acquire more skills and build knowledge to achieve our goals.

Professional Goals

I am looking to be a member of the team work in a reputable & successful company or organization where my knowledge and ability could be fully utilized .Which enables me to be professional while meeting the Company goal and to have a chance to develop my skills that will get more experience to meet my ambition.

WHY THESE FAIL

- They describe what the candidate wants, not what the employer gets.
- No role is named, so the same paragraph fits any application.
- No skill or tool appears, so there is nothing to match or search.
- Too long. A screener reading in seconds skips a dense block entirely.

Career Objective: Strong Examples

Same length as the weak versions. Far more information.

Objective

Highly skilled .NET Developer with experience in designing, developing, and maintaining web applications using the .NET framework. Proficient in C#, ASP.NET, MVC, and SQL Server with a strong background in full-stack development. Proven ability to deliver high-quality software solutions on time and within budget. Excellent problem-solving skills and a passion for continuous learning and professional development.

PROFILE

I am a Software Engineer with experience in building efficient web and mobile applications with a focus on good performance and user experience. I have strong skills in ASP.NET Core, Django, and Flutter. Skilled in both backend and frontend development, I provide complete solutions for complex projects. I focus on creating robust solutions and driving project success through well-crafted technology and strategic implementation.

WHY THESE WORK

- The role is named in the first three three words.
- Concrete technologies appear, which is what a search looks for.
- The level is stated, so the reader can place the candidate.
- They close on the value to the employer, not the candidate's ambition.

Role + Level + Core tools + Value

Education: The Five Elements

- **Degree**
Written in full: B.Sc., B.A., Bachelor of Commerce.
- **Major**
The specialisation the employer is screening for.
- **Institution**
Full official name, correctly capitalised.
- **Date**
Graduation month and year, or the study period.
- **Grade**
State it when it is competitive or requested.



Education: Common Mistakes

Read these as if you had four more CVs waiting.

EDUCATION

2018-2021

FACULTY OF COMMERCE

alexandria university

Education

- Bachelor of Engineering Ain Shams University, Egypt.

WHY THESE FAIL

- The degree is missing. A faculty name is not a qualification.
- The institution is written in lowercase on a document about your standards.
- No graduation date, no major, and no grade to compare against the requirement.

Education: Strong Examples

Education:

2019-2023: B.Sc. of Computer Science from Modern University for Technology & Information (MTI)

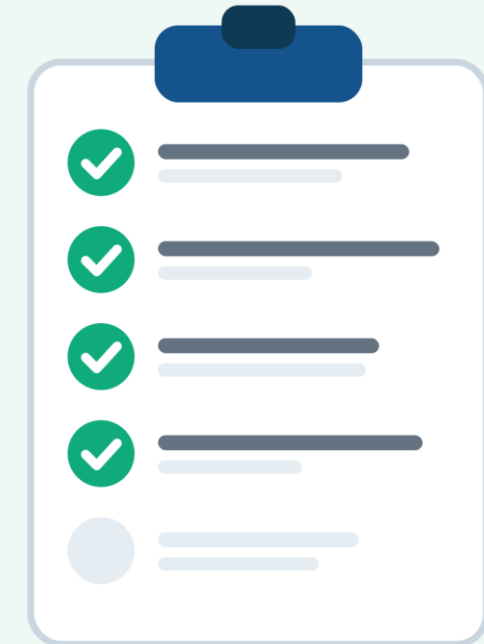
Education

Bachelor of Commerce, University of Mansoura, June 2019

- Major: Accounting
- General Grade: Good

THE RULE

- Reverse chronological order: your most recent qualification comes first, always.



Experience: The Bullet Formula

The section that carries more weight than any other.

Action verb + what you did + which tool + what changed

Weak

Responsible for the procurement of materials.

Strong

Procured materials for three national projects, keeping delivery on schedule.



Experience: Common Mistakes

Four real samples.

WORK EXPERIENCE

- experience (1.5 year oct 2020-2022)
- Diploma full stack developer .net
- experience (3 month dec 2022-march 2023)
- Training front end (with react js)
- (creativa) information technology institute
- El-Araby Group | Sep 2020- Nov 2020
Introduction to C programming by practicing problem solving.

Internships

- **Embedded systems**
summer internship program as intern at the artificial intelligence technology center (AITC)
February 2023
- **UI/UX Designer**
virtual internship program as a UI/UX Designer
by intern2grow
22-27october 2023

- Problem Solving**
Coach Academy
07/2021 – 09/2021
- Introduction to Programming in C++
 - Covered fundamentals of computer science and programming using C++.

- Competitive Programming**
Coach Academy
07/2022 – 09/2022
- Learned various sorting algorithms
 - Acquired skills in searching algorithms including Binary Search.
 - Gained proficiency in implementing these algorithms efficiently for competitive programming challenges.

- Internships**
- Codsoft company .
 - TechnHacks company .
 - Pioneers of Digital Egypt Initiative.

WHY THESE FAIL

- A spelling error in the section heading itself.
- Employer, role, and dates mixed together instead of on predictable lines.
- Bullets list what the role involved, never what the candidate achieved.
- No numbers anywhere, so every claim stays unverifiable.

Experience: Strong Example (Work)

The anatomy of an entry a screener reads in one pass.

Senior Procurement Engineer

May, 2022 – Oct, 2022

The Arab Contractors, Helwan Branch

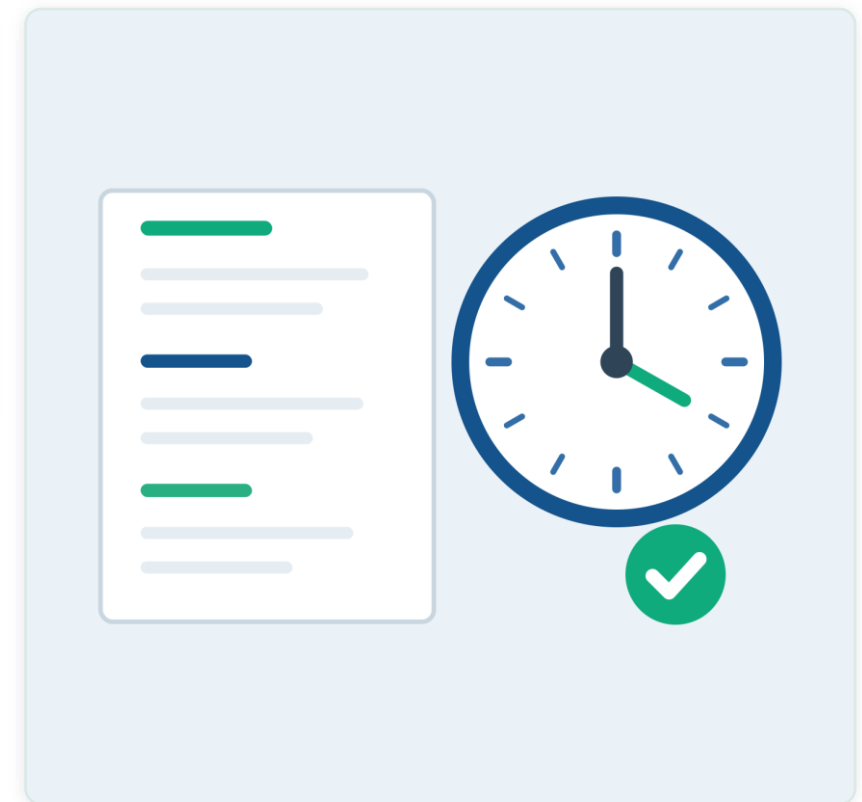
- Procure equipment, materials and systems that comply with project requirements
- Ensure timely delivery of equipment and materials to support site installation
- Maintain positive relationships with suppliers and subcontractors, ensuring company reputation and credibility.
- **Key Projects** : Cairo Monorail Project & The Islamic Cultural Center(Administrative Capital) & Egyptian Military Academy(Administrative Capital)

Line 1 Job title left, dates right. Same on every entry.

Line 2 Employer and location. Nothing else on this line.

Bullets Three to five, each opening with a past-tense verb.

Evidence Named projects and a scale the reader can picture.



Experience: Strong Example (Internship)

An internship is written with exactly the same discipline as a paid role.

BIM Structure Intern KAITECH, Egypt

(August 2021 – November 2021)

- Utilize BIM software such as Revit and Navisworks Dynamo BIM360 to develop and coordinate building design models in 3D.
- Collaborate with architects and engineers to integrate MEP systems into the building design.
- Conduct clash detection and resolution to identify and resolve design conflicts
- Create and manage construction documents including 2D drawings, schedules, and Specifications.

WHY THIS WORKS

- Role, organisation, and a clear date range.
- The tools are named, which is what a technical screen searches for.
- The scope is honest for an internship and does not pretend to be senior.



Courses and Certificates: Common Mistakes

A section that is usually written in a hurry.

Courses

2024	Power Distribution course
2023	Embedded Systems Diploma

Certificates

- (28 April 2023) Approaches to software development , Open University
- (3 March-13March2023) UI/UX design , Edrak.com
- (November 2022)Data analysis challenger track, Udacity
- (2 August 2021 -26 August 2021) UI/UX design , ITI

WHY THESE FAIL

- A course title with a year and no provider.
- Date formats that change from line to line.
- No length or depth, so a webinar looks like a diploma.
- Courses with no connection to the role being applied for.

Courses and Certificates: Strong Example

Four elements per entry, and every entry earns its place.

Problem Solving Coach Academy

07/2021 – 09/2021

- Introduction to Programming in C++
- Covered fundamentals of computer science and programming using C++.

Competitive Programming Coach Academy

07/2022 – 09/2022

- Learned various sorting algorithms
- Acquired skills in searching algorithms including Binary Search.
- Gained proficiency in implementing these algorithms efficiently for competitive programming challenges.

WHY THIS WORKS

- Title, provider, and date range, formatted the same way every time.
- A short line under each entry stating what was covered, which adds keywords.
- Entries relevant to the target role, so the section supports the application.

KEEP

- Recognised professional certifications
- Diplomas and tracks with real duration
- Anything the advert names directly

CUT

- One-hour webinars and attendance slips
- Courses unrelated to the role
- Anything you could not be questioned on

Skills: How to Write the Section

1

Group them

Technical skills, tools and platforms, languages. Three labelled blocks.

2

Name the technology

Write React, not modern frameworks. That is what a search matches.

3

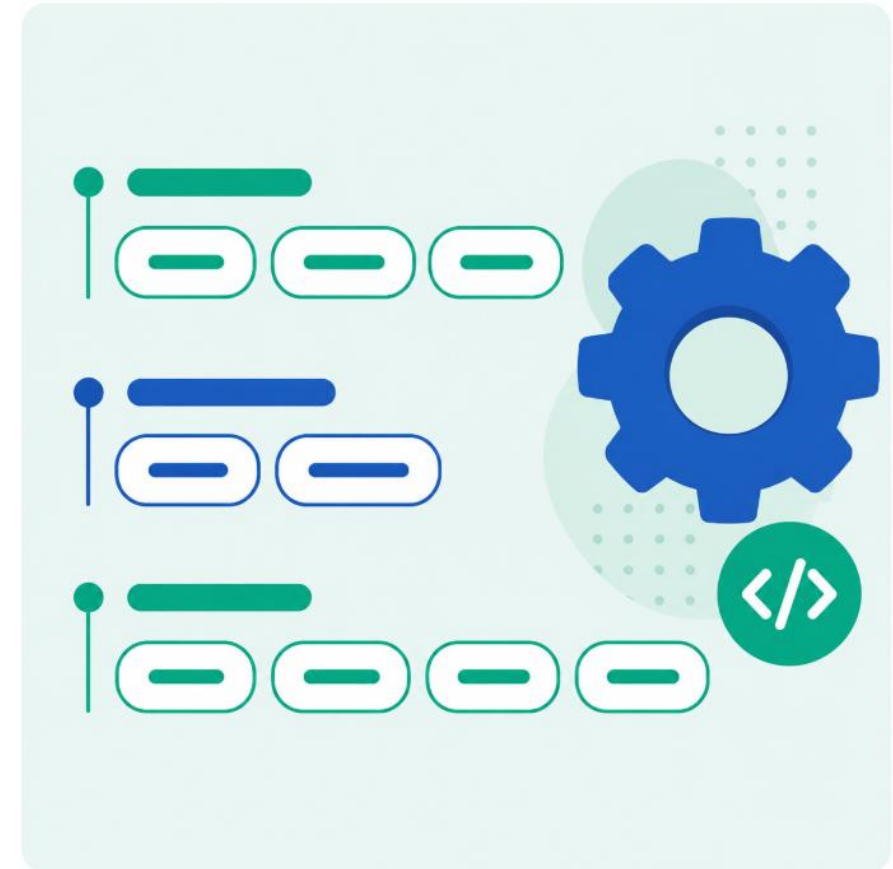
State an honest level

Proficient, familiar with, basic understanding. Three different claims.

4

Move soft skills out

Prove them in your Experience bullets, do not list them here.



Skills: Common Mistakes

Ask yourself what either sample tells a hiring manager.

SOFT SKILLS

- Self-motivated.
- Attention to details.
- Critical thinking.
- Communication.
- Team player.
- Curiosity.

SKILLS

- Excellent Command of PC skills. (Windows-Web browsing- Word- Excel)
- Problem Solving
- Basic knowledge in HTML and CSS.
- Excellent Written and Non-Written Communication.

WHY THESE FAIL

- Personality adjectives with no evidence anywhere in the CV to support them.
- Vague phrases such as excellent command of PC skills, which cannot be tested.
- Basic knowledge sitting beside real working skills, with no levels shown.
- No grouping, so the reader has to sort the list themselves.

Skills: Strong Examples

Grouped under headings, named exactly as the industry writes them.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- C# , c++
- JavaScript / ES6
- ASP .NET Core MVC
- React js
- RESTful API
- HTML5 / CSS3
- Entity Framework Core
- Bootstrap
- LINQ

Frontend development

- Html/CSS , JavaScript ,Bootstrap , UI/UX design ,Responsive Design

Backend development

- C# , LINQ , Microsoft SQL server , ASP Web API ,MVC .net core

Other

- Java programing language, Software engineering concepts, SOLD Principles

- Proficient in HTML, CSS, Sass Integration, and JavaScript.
- Familiar with modern front-end libraries and frameworks like React and BootStrap.
- Basic understanding of responsive web design.

Language Skills

Arabic: Native

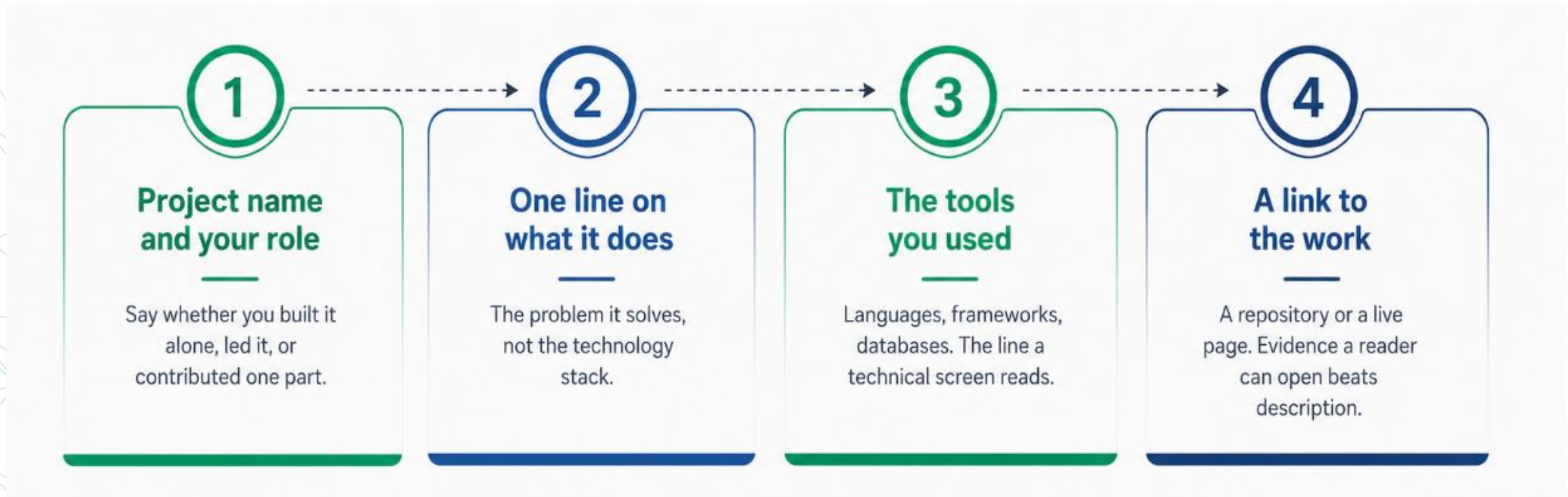
English: Very Good

French: Very Good

WHY THESE WORK

- Grouped under headings, so the reader finds what they need.
- Frontend and backend separated, so the candidate can be placed immediately.
- Honest levels: proficient, familiar with, basic understanding.
- Languages in their own labelled block, not buried in a general list.

Projects: When and What to Include



Projects: Strong Examples

- **kAPPot IOS Mobile Application (Graduation Project)**

Project Description: An application that helps users in emergency cases to order a specific car spare part or to get the nearest service centers to repair their car based on user location.

Tools swift 5, Firebase, Google Maps, Google places, Cocoapods.

GitHub Link: <https://github.com/xDeuxer/kAPPot>

- **Bikeshare System**

Project Description: The datasets selected for three major cities in the United States – Chicago, New York City, and Washington. The system allows users to rent bicycles on a very short-term basis for a price. And our project is to produce insights based on our dataset and answer interesting questions about it by computing descriptive statistics

Tools: Python.

Projects

E-commerce Platform Development

- Developed a comprehensive e-commerce platform using ASP.NET Core and Angular, featuring product listings, user authentication, shopping cart functionality, and payment integration.*

Inventory Management System

- Designed and implemented an inventory management system for a mid-sized company, utilizing ASP.NET MVC, Entity Framework, and SQL Server to manage stock levels, orders, and suppliers.*

WHY THESE WORK

- Name first, then the problem in plain language, then the tools.
- The first sample gives a repository link, which turns a claim into something verifiable.
- The second names the features built, so the scope of the work is clear.

Extracurricular Activities

An optional section. Include it only when it proves something the rest of the CV cannot.

"What changed because you were there?"

If the answer is nothing

- That is attendance. It belongs in a conversation, not on a CV.

If the answer is something

- Write the role you held, the scale, and the result you reached.



Extracurricular Activities: Common Mistake

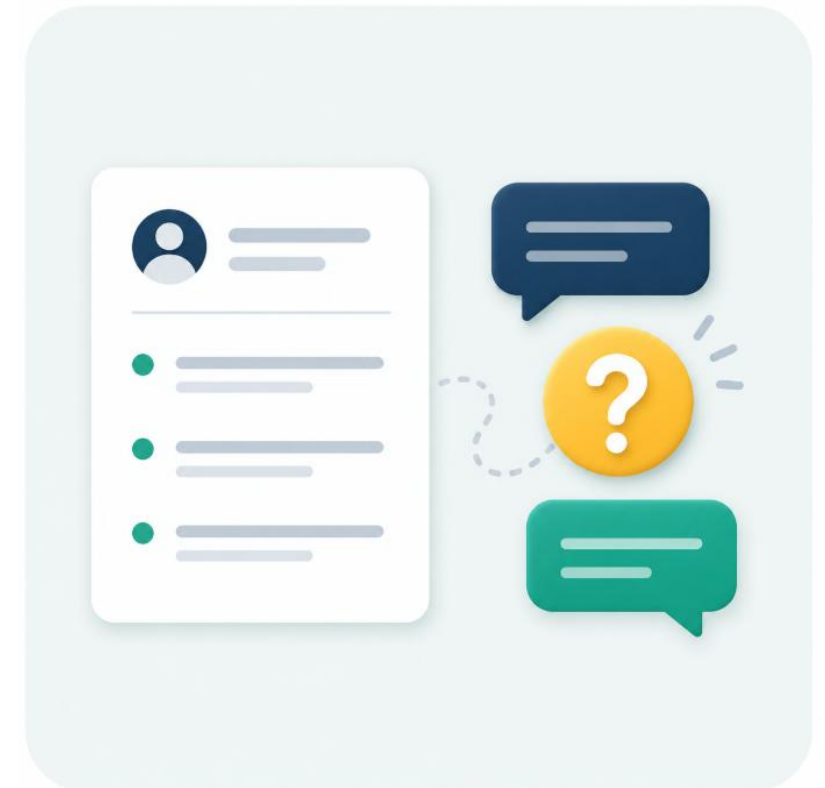
One real sample, written as a list of places.

Activity:

- EGYPT INTERNATIONAL EXHIBITION CENTER. (2019)
- EGYPT INTERNATIONAL EXHIBITION CENTER. (2020)
- Egypt International Summit for Digital Transformation and Cybersecurity (EISDTC). (2024)
- Volantiring at (سفرءاء- خير- أمة) (oct 2023)

WHY THIS FAILS

- Event names with no role attached, so nobody can tell what the candidate did.
- No contribution and no outcome, which leaves attendance as the only claim.
- Inconsistent language and formatting, including two languages in one entry.



Extracurricular Activities: Strong Example

Same section, written as a role with a scope and a result.

President and Project Manager, VIA Club, Cairo University (2017 - 2018)

- Managing a team of 100 members.
- Creating a program of 4 phases with 7 strong multinational companies (IBM, Cisco, Vodafone, UNODC, Deloitte, P&G, and Allianz).
- Funding our project with funds worth of 50,000 EGP.
- Reaching 55+k through our social media platform.

ONE MORE IMPROVEMENT

Switch the -ing verbs to past tense:

Managed a team of 100 members.

Built a four-phase program with seven partners.

Secured 50,000 EGP in funding.

Reached over 55,000 people.

Past tense states the work is finished and the result is yours.

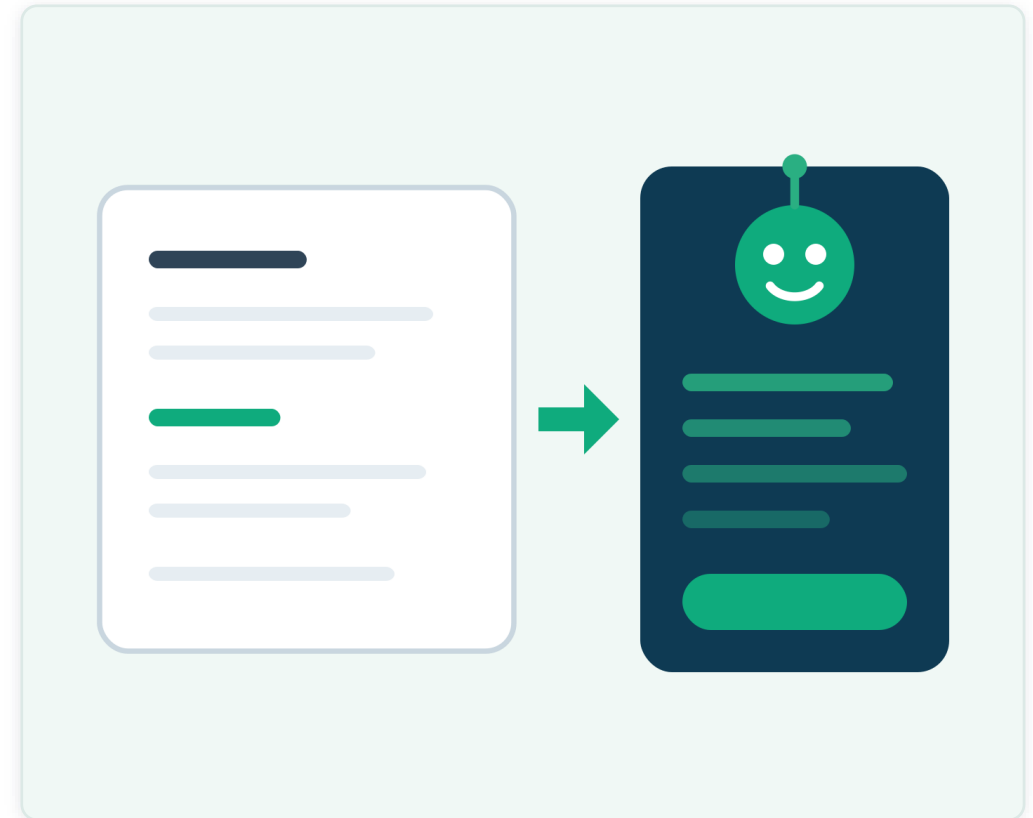
Where AI Helps, and Where It Must Not

AI CAN

- Find the keywords you are missing
- Restructure and shorten your bullets
- Critique and score a draft

AI MUST NOT

- Supply an experience you did not have
- Invent a number, a percentage, or a result
- Write a claim you could not defend in an interview



Activity - Tailor Your CV with an AI ATS Reviewer

1

Feed it the advert and your CV

Paste the full job advert, then your current CV text. Name the exact role you are targeting.

2

Extract the keyword map

Ask for the must-have and nice-to-have terms, and which ones your CV already proves.

3

Rewrite your weakest bullets

Ask for each as: action verb, task, tool, result. Then check every number yourself.

4

Score, cut, and humanise

Ask for a match score and the gaps, then delete any claim you could not defend.

READY-TO-USE PROMPT

"Act as an ATS screening tool and a technical recruiter.

Job advert: [paste the advert]. My CV: [paste your CV].

1) List the must-have and nice-to-have keywords in the advert.

2) Mark which ones my CV proves, and which are missing.

3) Rewrite my 5 weakest bullets as: action verb + task + tool + measurable result.

4) Give a match score out of 100 and the 3 highest-impact changes."

Output: a tailored, ATS-ready CV for one real job

Layout Rules: The Page

1

Length

One to two pages. One page for a fresh graduate.

2

Font

A clean, readable font. 10 to 12 pt body, 14 to 16 pt for your name.

3

Margins and spacing

Comfortable margins and white space between sections.

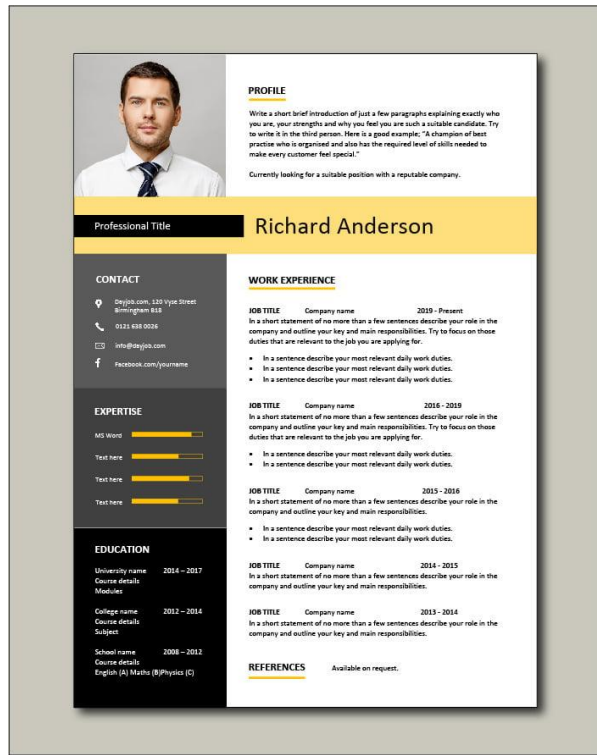


Layout Rules: The Structure



A Full CV: What Not to Do

Impressive to a human eye, close to zero in an automated screen.



Two columns

The parser reads across the page and merges both columns into one line.

Graphics and icons

They carry no text, so everything they represent is invisible.

Rating bars

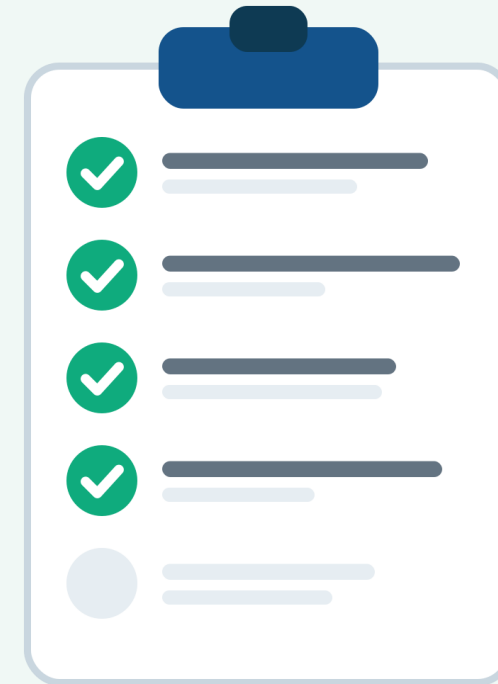
A four-out-of-five bar means nothing. Nobody knows the scale.

A photograph

No evidence, less space for content, and exposure to bias.

The Final CV Checklist

- ☐ No photo unless the employer asks for one
- ☐ Bullet points, never paragraphs
- ☐ Reverse chronological order, newest first
- ☐ Never copy and paste from anyone else
- ☐ Avoid templates built on tables and columns
- ☐ Send as PDF unless Word is requested





15 MINUTES

Interviewing Skills



What is a Competency-Based Interview?

A prepared list of questions

1

Asked of every candidate, so the process stays comparable and fair.

Each question tests one skill

2

Teamwork, problem solving, pressure. Nothing is asked by accident.

Answers are scored against criteria

3

The score decides the outcome, not the impression you left.



What this changes for you

A charming answer with no example scores lower than a plain answer with a real one. Prepare examples, not personality.

How Would You Prepare for a Job Interview?

Put your answer in the chat before the next slide.

You have an interview in three days for a role you want.

What do you do between now and then?

Research

Examples

Practice

Questions to ask

Logistics

Preparing for the Interview: Tips 1 to 5

1

Read the job advert

It is the syllabus for the interview.

2

Pick out the competencies

One example ready for each skill listed.

3

Research the company

What they do, what changed, who is interviewing you.

4

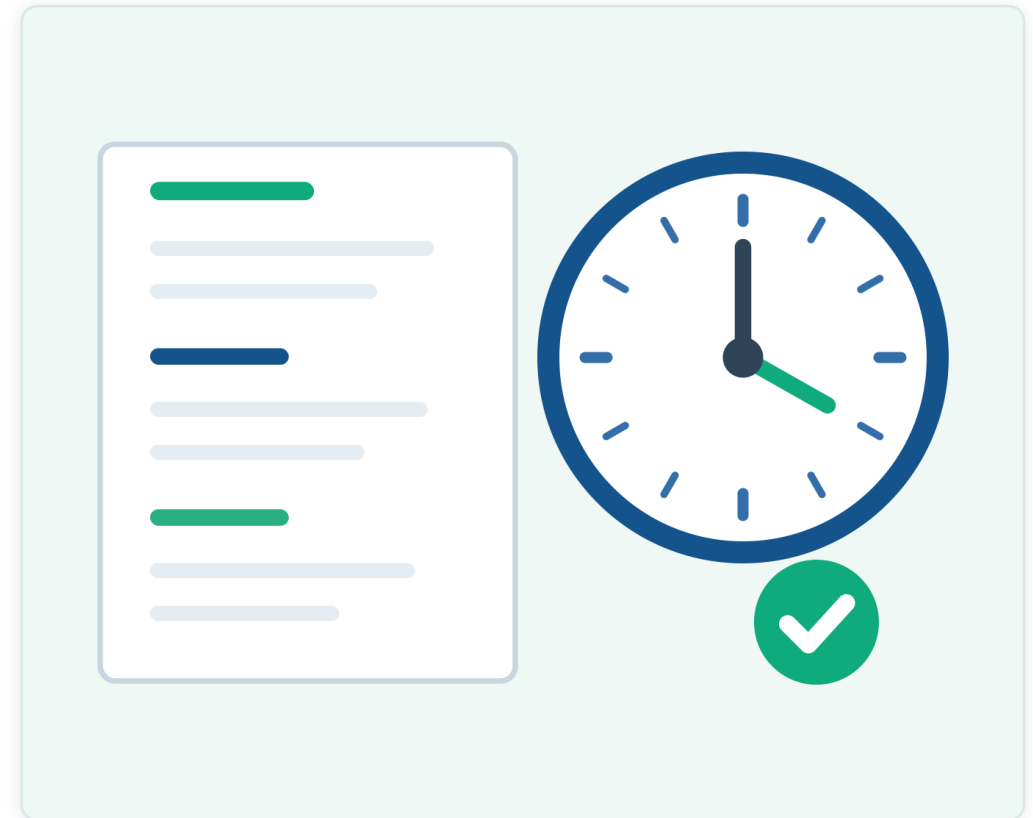
Prepare your introduction

Ninety seconds. Say it out loud.

5

Practise with a person

Not in your head. A listener interrupts.



Preparing for the Interview: Tips 6 to 10

1

Prepare your evidence

A real situation, action, and result per skill.

2

Prepare questions to ask

Two or three about the role or the team.

3

Come with an open mind

The role may not match what you expected.

4

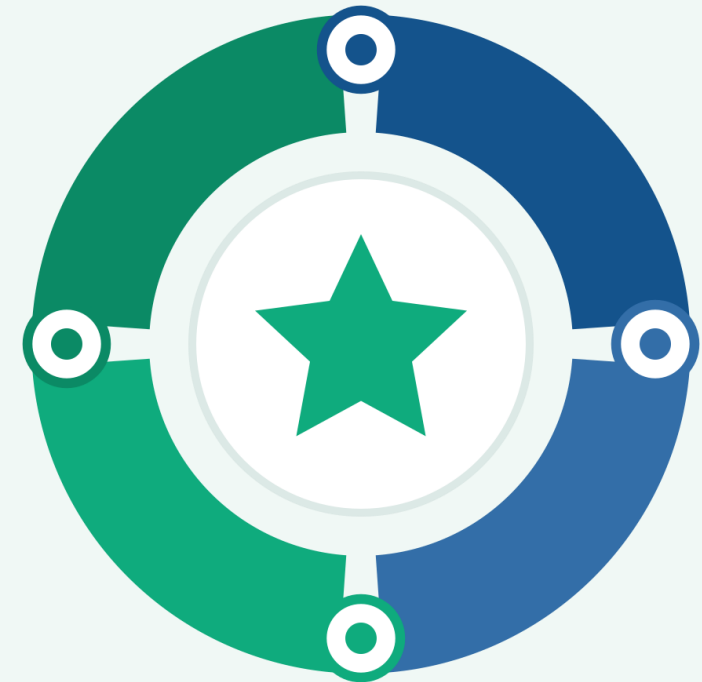
Mind body language and tone

Eye contact, open posture, a pace people follow.

5

Visualise success

It reduces the nerves that rush your answers.



Sample Questions: Motivation and Background

- 1 Introduce yourself.
- 2 Why do you want to work as a (job profile)?
- 3 Why do you want to work for XYZ?
- 4 What has been your biggest achievement so far?
- 5 What are your career goals?

WHAT IS BEING TESTED

Can you be concise?

Do you understand the role?

Did you prepare at all?

Can you structure evidence?

Will you still be here in two years?

Sample Questions: Competency-Based

- 1 Give an example of a team project that you achieved successfully.
- 2 Give me an example of a challenge you faced and how you overcame it.
- 3 Give an example of how you handled a difficult client successfully.
- 4 Give an example of a situation where you solved a problem creatively.
- 5 What would you do if ...

THE COMPETENCY BEHIND IT

Teamwork

Resilience and problem solving

Client handling and communication

Creative thinking

Judgement under a hypothetical

How to Answer: The STAR Method

S SITUATION

Set the context in one or two sentences.

T TASK

State the problem or responsibility that was yours.

A ACTION

What you did, in the first person. The longest part.

R RESULT

The outcome, with a number wherever you have one.

Keep Situation and Task short. Action and Result are what the interviewer is marking.

Activity - Rehearse with an AI Interviewer

1

Set the scene

Give the AI the job advert and your CV, and ask it to act as the hiring manager for that role.

2

Run a five-question mock

One question at a time. Say your answer out loud first, then type it.

3

Get scored against STAR

Ask it to mark each answer on Situation, Task, Action and Result, and name what is missing.

4

Rebuild your two weakest

Rewrite them with real numbers from your own history, then run the mock again.

READY-TO-USE PROMPT

"Act as the hiring manager interviewing me for this role: [paste the the advert]."

This is my CV: [paste your CV].

Ask me 5 competency-based questions, one at a time, and wait for my answer before the next.

After each answer, score it out of 5 on Situation, Task, Action and Result, and say exactly what evidence is missing.

At the end, name the 2 answers I should rebuild first."

Output: 5 STAR-scored answers and a and a rehearsal plan

Recap

Now we know how to:

- Write for the two steps where a CV is searched and screened
- Format a document that both a system and a person can read
- Build every section on evidence, not adjectives
- Tell a weak sample from a strong one, and judge your own the same way
- Answer a competency question with STAR, in the first person
- Use AI to tailor and rehearse, and verify every claim it produces



Thank You!

Thank you for your participation and attention.

